absolutely didn't want to snip off any balls. Where did I draw the line?

At suffering, that's where. I didn't want to go all Henry VIII on that goat mainly because I wasn't skilled in the art, and if I missed or miscalculated the poor thing would suffer.

The Gurkha nodded. *As you wish, saab*.

He swung the kukri.

Even after the goat's head hit the ground, I remember, its yellow eyes kept blinking.

15.

My job at Delhi was similar to the one I'd had at Dwyer. Only the hours were different. Constant. At Delhi I was on call, day and night.

The ops room was a former classroom. Like seemingly everything else in Afghanistan, the school that housed Delhi had been bombed—dangling wood beams, tipped-over desks, floors scattered with spilled papers and books—but the ops room looked as if it had been ground zero. A disaster area. On the plus side, during night shifts, the many holes in the walls gave a stunning view of the stars.

I recall one shift, around one A.M. I asked a pilot overhead for his code, so I could key it into my Rover and see his feed.

The pilot answered sourly that I was doing it wrong.

Doing what wrong?

It's not the Rover, it's the Longhorn.

The Long what?

You're new, huh?

He described the Longhorn, a machine no one had bothered to tell me about. I looked around, found it. Big black briefcase covered with dust. I brushed it off, turned it on. The pilot talked me through getting it